



METHODOLOGY

The INDIA TODAY-AC Nielsen-ORG MARG Sex Survey 2008 was carried out to understand the different facets of sexuality of single and married men and women. The survey was conducted among men and women of three age groups: 18-25 years, 26-34 years and 35-40 years. They belonged to the middle and upper middle-class (Sec A and B).

In this year's survey, we talked about under-age sex, sex with prostitutes and eunuchs, kinky sex, adultery, incest sex, homosexuality, fantasies, preferences, favourite positions, attitudes towards role-playing and other sexual activities. We had a robust sample size of 5,353 respondents across 11 cities: Delhi, Chennai, Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, Patna, Mumbai, Bangalore, Lucknow, Jaipur, Ludhiana and Kolkata. The respondents were divided almost equally in terms of their gender: there were 2,685 males and 2,668 females.

The study was divided in two phases. In the first phase, recruitment interviews were done where respondents were asked basic questions regarding their demographics and their consent was taken for participating in the survey anonymously. This was followed by the second phase in which they were asked to complete a self-administered questionnaire. We tried to use interviewers who had experience in handling such sensitive issues. In most cases, the same teams which conducted the earlier sex surveys were given the task.

To protect the identity of the respondents, a ballot box was kept at the venue where each respondent came and dropped the questionnaire filled by him/her without their name or contact details. Given that the questionnaire contained a number of sensitive issues, quite a few respondents chose not to reply to a few questions. Their views are highly respected.

Have you ever committed adultery?

		Male	Female
Yes	26	41	8
No	6	9	3
Thought about it	1	1	1
No response	67	50	88

For 3,923 respondents of the total of 5,353 who have had sex. The figures have been rounded to the nearest integer. All figures in per cent.

With whom have you committed adultery?

		Male	Female
Ex-girlfriend/boyfriend	52	53	45
Neighbour	38	41	20
College friends	16	17	13
Colleagues	13	14	9
Family friend	8	8	10
Relatives	12	12	16
Prostitute	15	17	3

For 1,037 respondents of the total of 5,353 who have committed adultery. The figures add up to more than 100 due to multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

cent of those surveyed have had sex before 20, a figure that social anthropologist Pervuez Mody points out is comparable to the 37 per cent of Britons who lose their virginity before age 16.

Kinky sex is more than a blip on the urban Indian's radar. Twenty per cent of adulterous couples (that is 1,037 of the total respondents) have tried swapping partners, 18 per cent of all respondents think trying new things in bed helps boost their sex life and anal, bisexual and sado-masochistic sex figure high in the score of sexual experiments they have checked out. Clearly, a bit of rough goes a long way. Much of these fantasies are being fed by the glamour and pornographic industries. Both men and women seem to share a taste for titillation, especially for home-grown and celebrity porn. Technology has freed their bodies, though their minds may still be trapped in a twisted moral universe. There is a hint